C58

□ **Chapter 5**

■ **4.Ng5 8.Qf3**

Ambitious Italian and Scotch for Black *[GM Lucas Van Foreest]*

1.e4 e5 2.♘f3 ♘c6 3.♗c4 ♘f6 4.♘g5 Has gained some popularity over the last few years. Prior to that it was seen as a tricky but not so serious option for White. But, with the help of engine's White is actually playing for an advantage these days. Given how sharp the line is, Black definitely needs to study it and be prepared against it. **4...d5 5.exd5 ♘a5** Against Ng5 I believe that it's the best to play solid and correct, as it is White who is already facing complications. **6.♗b5+**

[6.d3 A rare and old line, but recently it was played against me by the Icelandic GM Vignir Stefansson in a real game, so we should definetly briefly check it. h6 7.♘f3 e4 8.♘d4 This is the new move that Vignir discovered, but still I don't think that it's great for White. *(8.♕e2?!* By far the most common, but it's not a good move. *♘xc4 9.dxc4 ♗c5∓* With a great position.*; 8.dxe4?* Was played in a few old games. *♘xc4 9.♕d4 ♘b6 10.c4* White has played like this in a few games, including one by David Bronstein, but: *♘bd7-+* The engine is screaming that Black is completely winnning. *)* 8...♗c5 This is what I played, and after this, Black is doing more than fine.

A) 9.♗e3 More common than c3. exd3 10.♗b5+ c6 11.♗xd3 *(*On: *11.dxc6* We can just continue: *0-0∓* With a very active, and good position. *)* 11...♘xd5∓ A very good position for Black.;

B) 9.c3 0-0 10.0-0 ♖e8∓ At some moment we will recoup the pawn on d5, and Black has a good, and slightly better position.]

6...c6 7.dxc6 bxc6 Here White has three options, and we will look at the most sharp one in this Chapter. **8.♕f3** The most sharp line in the 4.Ng5 lines. White needs to be very well prepared, and even then he is still risking quite a bit. I played this myself with succes a couple of years back against Amin Bassem, and although Black has many options, none of them lead to simple positions for either colour.

[8.♗e2 The old main line, and we will cover it in the next Chapter.]

[8.♗d3 The popular line nowadays, and we will look at it closer in Chapters 7 and 8.]

8...cxb5 Old engine's determined that Black is simply down an exchange, but recent ones see that there is plenty of compensation for Black. **9.♕xa8 ♕c7** I believe that this new line, sacrificing the exchange, is one of the best lines for Black. We have incredible activity, and still the line is just beginning. **10.♕f3** Forced.

[10.♘c3? Played 21 times, somehow, but this is just losing. ♘c6 11.♘xb5 ♕d7∓ We can just develop our bishop, castle, and Bb7 will be a deadly threat.]

10...♘c6 Threatening Nd4 **11.c3 ♗g4**

[11...♘d4? Doesn't work due to: 12.♕d1± And the knight has to move back again. *(12.cxd4* White can even take. *♕xc1+ 13.♕d1+-* With a winning position for White. *)*]

12.♕g3

[12.♕e3? Played two times, but the queen is exposed here. h6 White has no good moves. 13.f3 Was played in the only game that reached this position. *(13.♘e4 ♘d5* With f5 next. *14.♕g3 f5* And White is basically out of moves. For example: *15.0-0 ♘f4-+* Just a horrible position for White.*; 13.♘h3 ♘b4* With the threat of Nc2. *14.♘a3 ♘bd5 15.♘xb5* White hopes for some counterplay. *♕c4 16.♕xe5+ ♔d7-+* Black has an overwhelming initiative.*; 13.♘f3* Here Black chases down the queen again. *♘d5 14.♕e4 ♘f4-+* f5 next, and Black is winning. *)* 13...♗d7 14.♘h3 *(14.♘e4* Again Black has: *♘d5 15.♕e2 ♘f4 16.♕f1 ♘b4-+* Just winning for Black. *)* 14...♘b4 15.♘a3 ♘bd5 The queen now has to move again. 16.♕d3 ♗c5 Black is much better.]

12...♗f5N We will play a bit slower, and although we are down an exchange and a pawn, our activity is enough compensation.

[12...♘d4 This is how the main line continues, but involves quite some theory, and White might be well prepared.]

13.0-0

[13.a4 White is trying to open up the rook, and at the same time makes a prophylaxis against Nb4. b4 Of course, we don't want to activate White's rook, so we close the file. *(13...♘b4?* Doesn't work now. *14.0-0 ♘c2 15.♖a2+-* White just moves the rook up, Black wasted two moves and misplaced the knight. *)* 14.0-0 h6 15.♘h3 ♕d7! Black is completely fine. *(15...g5 16.d4∞* Still fine, but we move ordered ourselves. *)* 16.d3 Best, according to the engine. *(16.d4* Probably the most logical move. *exd4 17.cxd4 ♗e7∓* Amazing positional compensation. *)* 16...♗c5 Difficult for White to avoid repetition Nh5-Bg4-Bf5. For example: 17.♗e3 ♘h5 18.♕f3 ♗g4 19.♕e4 We can play on with Be7, or just make the draw by repetition. ♗f5=]

[13.d3? Is a mistake due to of: ♘b4! 14.0-0 ♘c2∓ Now the rook on a1 will fall, and this is just good for Black.]

13...h6 14.♘h3 g5 Attacking, and at the same time hindering White's pieces.

[14...♕d7? Is not good here due to: 15.d4 exd4 16.cxd4 ♗e7± And without the inclusion of a4 and b4, White can for example play Nc3, and is doing much better.]

15.a4

[15.d4 Here we can go: ♗d6 16.a4 exd4 17.♕f3 ♘e7 Here a crazy line begins. 18.♘a3 g4 *(18...0-0=* Is also possible with a

complicated, but level position. *)* 19.♕a8+ ♔d7 20.♕xh8 ♗xh2+ 21.♔h1 gxh3 Here White should accept the draw with: 22.♕xf6 hxg2+ 23.♔xg2 ♗e4+ 24.♔h3 ♗f5+= With a perpetual.]

15...g4

[15...b4∞ Important to realize that this is different than the b4 that we played against 13.a4, as here we have already committed to g5! Although this is still fine for Black, I prefer our main line.]

16.axb5 gxh3 17.♕f3

Forced, Rg8 was a devastating threat. **17...♘e7** Saving both pieces. And now e4 is a big threat. **18.d3** Against e4, and also preparing Be3. **18...♗g7 19.♗e3** Here we have a rather forced line. **19...♕c8 20.♖xa7 ♘ed5 21.b6 0-0 22.b7 ♕b8∞** After 12...Bf5N, white had to find 10 accurate moves, to reach this is a very chaotic position where the engine is saying that everything is 0.00, as usual :)